

Chinese
中文
[tʃʊnwən]

github.com/cb-g/bhasa

January 10, 2026

1 Phonology

1.1 Vowels

i	close front unrounded vowel
u	close back rounded vowel
y	close front rounded vowel
a	open vowel
ə	mid central vowel (schwa)
ɜ	close-mid central unrounded vowel

1.2 Consonants

m	voiced bilabial nasal
n	voiced alveolar nasal
ŋ	voiced velar nasal
p	voiceless bilabial plosive (unaspirated)
p ^h	voiceless bilabial plosive (aspirated)
t	voiceless alveolar plosive (unaspirated)
t ^h	voiceless alveolar plosive (aspirated)
k	voiceless velar plosive (unaspirated)
k ^h	voiceless velar plosive (aspirated)
ts	voiceless alveolar affricate (unaspirated)
ts ^h	voiceless alveolar affricate (aspirated)
ʈ̪̺	voiceless retroflex affricate (unaspirated)
ʈ̪̺ ^h	voiceless retroflex affricate (aspirated)
tɕ	voiceless alveolo-palatal affricate (unaspirated)
tɕ ^h	voiceless alveolo-palatal affricate (aspirated)
f	voiceless labiodental fricative
s	voiceless alveolar fricative
ʂ	voiceless retroflex fricative
ɕ	voiceless alveolo-palatal fricative
x h	voiceless velar/glottal fricative
l	voiced alveolar lateral approximant
ʐ ɭ	voiced retroflex approximant
j	voiced palatal approximant
w	voiced labio-velar approximant

1.3 Tones

˥	tone 1 (high-level); endonym: jì:n˥p ^h iŋ˥ or yīnpíng
˨˨˦	tone 2 (high-rising); endonym: jāŋ˥p ^h iŋ˥ or yángpíng
˨˨˦	tone 3 (low-rising); endonym: cəŋ˨˨˦ or sǎng
˥˩	tone 4 (high-falling); endonym: tɕ ^h y˥˩ or qù
(neutral)	neutral tone (weak syllables); endonym: tɕ ^h iŋ˥cəŋ˥ or qīngshēng

2 Glosses

- (1) woʌ ʂɿ̃ⁿ tsĩⁿjou¹
wǒ shì zìyóu
1SG be free

我是自由。
I am free.

- (2) niʌ ʂɿ̃ⁿ woʌ də̃ⁿ pəŋ¹jouʌ
nǐ shì wǒ de péngyǒu
2SG be 1SG GEN friend

你是我的朋友。
You are my friend.

- (3) woʌmən ɕjaŋ¹ xwej¹ tɕja¹
wǒmen xiǎng huí jiā
1PL want return home

我们想回家。
We want to go home.